SEO strategy template: your 12-month SEO plan

Your SEO strategy in one document: from the business goal through keywords, target pages, content, technical SEO, local SEO, links and AI search visibility, to a quarterly roadmap, measurement, risks and budget. Fill it in by hand or in a PDF editor.

How to use this template

1. **Capture your baseline** (part 3): 12 months of Search Console and GA4 data, your Google Business Profile, and AI answers to customer questions. Write down the date.
2. **Turn the business goal into an SEO goal** (part 2): a number of organic leads, a deadline and a data source.
3. **Group keywords into clusters** (part 4): one cluster, one target page.
4. **Pick technical, local, link and AI priorities** (parts 6–9). From the audit, only what blocks the goal.
5. **Plan content and build the quarterly roadmap** (parts 5 and 10): every piece in a cluster, one objective and one success measure per quarter.
6. **Set measurement, risks, owners and budget** (parts 11 and 12).
7. **Fill in part 1 last**, the one-page summary, and book the first quarterly review.

Company		**Website**	
Date prepared		**Version / review**	

1. One-page strategy

Fill this in last. It is the page you show leadership and come back to at every review.

Strategy period (from – to)	
Business goal (one sentence)	
SEO goal: organic leads per month in Q4	
Top three keyword clusters and their pages	
Main objective for Q1 / Q2 / Q3 / Q4	
Biggest risk and response	
Monthly budget	
Strategy owner on the company side	
Date of the first quarterly review	

2. Business goals and SEO goals

Every level gets a number, a source and a deadline. Track leads (forms, calls, emails) as key events in GA4. Rankings are a supporting target; the strategy is judged on leads.

Level	Goal	Target	Data source	Deadline
Business goal			Sales data, CRM	
SEO goal (leads)			GA4 key events	
Leading indicator (non-branded clicks)			Search Console	
Activity goal (rankings, Maps, AI)			Rank tracker, map grid, AI questions	

Example (illustrative numbers): a home renovation company. Business goal: more bathroom remodeling jobs in the second half of the year → SEO goal: for example, 25 organic leads per month in Q4 (GA4) → leading indicator: year-over-year growth in non-branded clicks (Search Console) → activity goal: the service page in the top 3 for an agreed keyword list and the Business Profile in the top 3 across most grid points.

3. Baseline

Use the last 12 months, before any changes to the site. If data is missing, write "none": that becomes the first task in the plan.
Date: _____

Metric	Value today	Source
Non-branded clicks, last 12 months		Search Console
Organic Search leads per month		GA4
Pages with the most clicks		Search Console
Queries in positions 4–20		Search Console
Non-indexed pages and main reasons		Search Console, Page indexing
Mobile share of search traffic		GA4
Business Profile ranking in Maps		Grid-based rank tracking
Business Profile reviews: count and average rating		Google Business Profile
AI answers that name the business (out of how many)		Fixed set of customer questions
Main competitors in search and AI		Google results, AI answers

4. Keyword clusters and target pages

A cluster is a group of keywords with the same intent. If at least 4 or 5 of the top 10 URLs for two keywords are the same, one page is enough. Two pages chasing the same queries weaken each other. Priority = closeness to purchase + closeness to the top 10; for a long list, an ICE score (impact × confidence × ease, 1–10).

Cluster	Sample keywords	Intent	Target page	Action (new / expand / merge)	Priority
Example: bathroom remodeling	*bathroom remodeling contractor, bathroom remodel near me*	*Hire a contractor*	*Service page /bathroom-remodeling*	*Expand: pricing, project photos, FAQ*	*High*
1.					
2.					
3.					
4.					
5.					
6.					
7.					

5. Content plan by quarter

Every piece belongs to a cluster from part 4. Updating a strong page is often faster than writing a new one.

Quarter	New content	Updates and merges	Cluster	Owner
Q1				
Q2				
Q3				
Q4				

6. Technical priorities

Only fixes that block the goal. Keep the full audit list in an appendix.

	Area	Pages	Owner	Deadline
☐	Service pages are indexed (Page indexing report)			
☐	301 redirects without chains or loops			
☐	Core Web Vitals on mobile: LCP ≤ 2.5 s, INP ≤ 200 ms, CLS ≤ 0.1			
☐	Canonical tags, no duplicate content			
☐	Structured data that matches the page: organization or local business, breadcrumbs			
☐	Internal links to service pages			
☐	Other:			

7. Local SEO

For businesses serving a specific city or region. Track rankings on a grid of points, not from one location.

- ☐ Primary and secondary Business Profile categories: _____
- ☐ Services and descriptions completed in the profile: _____
- ☐ Review plan (who asks, when, which channel): _____
- ☐ Consistent name, address and phone across directories: _____
- ☐ Areas covered by grid-based rank tracking: _____

8. Link building

Start with the target page, then the source. One link from a closely related site to a service page usually beats several random ones. Do not buy links.

Target page	Source type	Example sources	Links per quarter	Owner

9. AI search visibility (GEO)

A fixed set of questions your customers ask. Tick the box when the answer names your business, and note who was recommended instead. Search Console does not separate clicks from AI Overviews, so this tracking is separate.

Customer question	ChatGPT	Gemini	Perplexity	AI Overviews	Recommended instead
1.	☐	☐	☐	☐	
2.	☐	☐	☐	☐	
3.	☐	☐	☐	☐	
4.	☐	☐	☐	☐	
5.	☐	☐	☐	☐	
6.	☐	☐	☐	☐	

Check frequency: _____ Number of questions: _____

10. Quarterly roadmap (12 months)

One objective per quarter. Order: tracking and technical → content → authority → scale and review. Starting split of effort: about 40% content, 30% technical, 20% links, 10% experiments. Log changes with a date and a reason.

	Objective	Content	Technical	Local and links	AI search (GEO)	Success measure
Q1						
Q2						
Q3						
Q4						

11. Measurement, reporting and risks

A review rhythm keeps the strategy alive. Remember: no one can guarantee a #1 ranking on Google. Rankings are a supporting target; the main goal is growth in leads and clicks.

What we measure	How often	Source	Who gets it
Rankings for the agreed keyword list and share of voice against competitors	Weekly, monthly in the report		
Visibility in AI answers	Weekly or monthly, same questions		
Organic leads and non-branded clicks (also year over year)	Monthly		
Strategy and roadmap review	Quarterly		
Annual summary and next year's plan	Yearly		

Risk	Likelihood (low / medium / high)	Response	Owner

12. Owners and budget

For each workstream, one person on the company side and one on the agency side.

Workstream	Company owner	Agency owner	Monthly budget
Ongoing SEO			
Content			
Link building			
Development work			
Local SEO			
AI search visibility			
Tools			
Total			

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